



# Collecting consumer data

Capturing key data is a priority for any business seeking to understand the marketplace. However, the task requires the use of innovative strategies to circumvent consumer sensitivity about privacy issues.

## How it works

There are a number of methods companies use to collect customer data. When there is contact between a customer and the company, marketers can use the opportunity to gather as much information as possible. This might happen at the point of sale in a store or online, where marketers are able to observe customer behavior.

Marketers may also choose to solicit information directly by asking their customers to fill in registration forms and conducting telemarketing calls or customer surveys.

## Collecting data to create consumer profile

Digital marketing and e-commerce have accelerated the rate at which customer information is gathered. Some methods require the customer's input, such as questionnaires that appear online. Others, such as website tracking, are possible without the need to contact the customer.



### Surveys

Gather customer feedback via email, text, or mail, and face-to-face questionnaires.



### Observations

Study customer's behavior while they shop in a store or online.



### Customer research

Conduct research on existing customers or on those who fit the customer profile.



### Contact center

Monitor customer calls and store data on preferences and purchase history.



## WARNING

### Data collection errors

- **Barraging** Using a customer's data to bombard them with information on products viewed or sites visited
- **Overlooking technical flaws** Failing to integrate apps properly, leading to inconsistency (and errors) in collecting customer data
- **Using only automated systems** Neglecting the opportunity to strengthen relationships with customers by communicating with them personally